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MorphTE: Injecting Morphology in Tensorized Embeddings

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Abstract

In the era of deep learning, word embeddings are essential when dealing with text tasks. However, storing and accessing these embeddings requires a large amount of space. This is not conducive to the deployment of these models on resource-limited devices. Combining the powerful compression capability of tensor products, we propose a word embedding compression method with morphological augmentation, **Morphologically-enhanced Tensorized Embeddings** (**MorphTE**). A word consists of one or more **morphemes**, the smallest units that bear meaning or have a grammatical function. MorphTE represents a word embedding as an entangled form of its morpheme vectors via the **tensor product**, which injects prior semantic and grammatical knowledge into the learning of embeddings. Furthermore, the dimensionality of the morpheme vector and the number of morphemes are much smaller than those of words, which greatly reduces the parameters of the word embeddings. We conduct experiments on tasks such as machine translation and question answering. Experimental results on four translation datasets of different languages show that MorphTE can compress word embedding parameters by about 20 times without performance loss and significantly outperforms related embedding compression methods.

1 Introduction

The word embedding layer is a key component of the neural network models in natural language processing (NLP). It uses an embedding matrix to map each word into a dense real-valued vector. However, when the vocabulary size and word embedding size (dimensionality) are large, the word embedding matrix requires a large number of parameters. For example, the One Billion Word task of language modeling [8] has a vocabulary size ($|V|$) of around $800K$. Besides, the embedding size (d) can range from 300 to 1024 [30, 11, 22]. Storing and accessing the $|V| \times d$ embedding matrix requires a large amount of disk and memory space. This limits the deployment of these models on such devices having limited resources. To resolve this issue, there are many studies compressing embedding layers [32, 15, 27]. They can be roughly divided into two lines: **product quantization-based** and **decomposition-based** methods. The product quantization-based methods [32, 20, 36] mainly utilize the compositional coding for constructing the word embeddings with fewer parameters, and it needs to introduce an additional task to learn the compact code for each word.

The decomposition-based word embedding compression methods are mostly based on low-rank matrix factorization [18, 9] and tensor decomposition [15, 27]. Utilizing low-rank matrix factorization, ALBERT [18] replaces the embedding matrix with the product of two small matrices. Inspired by quantum entanglement, Word2ket and Word2ketXS embeddings are proposed [27]. Specifically,

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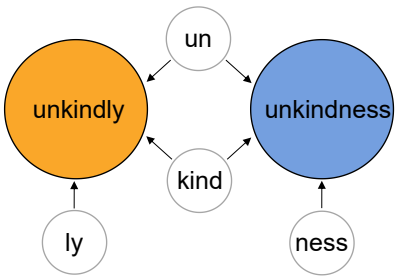

图 1：“unkindly”和“unkind- ness”的语素。

表 1：构词现象。

Phenomenon	Example
Inflection	cook+s, cook+ed, cook+ing cold+er, cold+est
Derivation	un+like, un+like+ly im+poss+ible, im+poss+ibly
Compounding	police+man, post+man cuttle+fish, gold+fish

Word2ket 将单词嵌入表示为通过张量积的多个小向量（张量）的纠缠张量。纠缠形式与规范多元分解基本一致[16]。基于分解的方法使用多个小矩阵和张量来近似原始的大单词嵌入矩阵。然而，这些小矩阵或张量有 *no specific meaning* 和 *lack interpretation*，而带有它们的 *approximate substitution* 通常会损害复杂 NLP 任务（如机器翻译）中的模型性能 [15， 27]。

在这项研究中，我们专注于高质量的压缩词嵌入。为此，我们提出了 *Morphologically-enhanced Tensorized Embeddings* (MorphTE)，它在张量化嵌入中注入形态学知识。具体来说，MorphTE 通过张量积将单词的嵌入建模为其语素向量的纠缠形式。值得注意的是，细粒度语素可以提高单词嵌入的质量，这已在文献中得到验证 [4， 5]。

在 MorphTE 中引入语素形态的好处可以总结为两点。（1） 单词由语素组成，这些语素被认为是语言中最小的意义承载或语法单位 [24]。如图 1 所示，根 'kind' 决定了 'unkindly' 和 'unkindness' 的 *underlying meanings*。词缀 'un'、'ly' 和 'ness' *grammatically* 分别指否定词、副词和名词。在 MorphTE 中，使用这些有意义的语素来生成词嵌入，将先验的语义和语法知识显式注入到词嵌入的学习中。（2） 如表 1 所示，单词形成中的屈折和派生等语言现象使形态相似的单词通常在语义上相关。在 MorphTE 中，这些相似的词可以通过共享相同的语素向量来连接。

MorphTE 只需要训练和存储语素向量，这些向量的嵌入大小和词汇大小都比原始单词嵌入小，因此参数更少。例如，可以通过张量积使用三个大小为 8 的语素向量生成大小为 512 的单词嵌入。此外，由于语素是单词的基本单位，因此语素词汇的大小小于单词词汇的大小。综上所述，MorphTE 可以学习高质量且节省空间的词嵌入，结合形态学的先验知识和张量积的压缩能力。

我们对机器翻译、基于检索的问答和自然语言推理任务进行了比较实验。与相关的词嵌入压缩方法相比，我们提出的 MorphTE 在这些任务上实现了更好的模型性能。与 Word2ket 相比，MorphTE 在 De-En、En-It 和 En-Ru 数据集上分别实现了 0.7、0.6 和 0.6 的 BLEU 分数提升。此外，在 4 个不同语言的翻译数据集上，我们的方法可以在将词嵌入的参数数量压缩 20 倍以上，并将词嵌入占总参数的比例大约从 30% 降低到 2% 时保持原始性能，而其他压缩方法会损害性能。

我们工作的主要贡献可以总结如下：

- 我们提出了 MorphTE，这是一种用于单词嵌入的新型压缩方法，使用具有形态学的纠缠张量的形式。语素和张量积的组合可以在词汇表和嵌入大小方面压缩单词嵌入。
- MorphTE 从细粒度语素的角度引入词嵌入学习中的先验语义知识，并通过共享语素向量显式地对词之间的联系进行建模。这些使它能够学习高质量的压缩嵌入。

- Experiments on multiple languages and tasks show that MorphTE can compress word embedding parameters over 20 times without hurting the original performance.

2 Related Work

Morphologically-augmented Embeddings. Related works [23, 4, 5, 29, 2, 10] propose to improve the quality of word embeddings by integrating morphological information. Representing word embeddings as the sum of morpheme and surface form vectors has been employed in several studies [5, 29, 2]. Morphological RNNs [5] learns word representations using morphemes as units of recursive neural networks [33]. Our proposed MorphTE also utilizes the information of morphemes and is a decomposition-based word embedding compression method, similar to Word2ket [27].

Decomposition-based Compression Embeddings. Decomposition-based methods are either based on low-rank matrix factorization [18, 9, 1, 21, 19] or tensor decomposition [15, 41, 27, 34]. Based on low-rank matrix factorization, ALBERT [18] simply approximates the embedding matrix by the product of two small matrices. GroupReduce [9] and DiscBlock [19] perform a fine-grained matrix factorization. They first block the word embedding matrix according to the word frequency and then approximate each block. Notably, the method based on matrix factorization has a low-rank bottleneck, and its expressive ability is limited under the condition of a high compression ratio [35].

As for the tensor decomposition, TT embeddings [15] uses the Tensor Train decomposition [25] to approximate the embedding matrix with several 2-order and 3-order tensors. TT-Rec [41] improves TT embeddings in terms of implementation and initialization to fit the recommended scenario. Word2ket [27] represents a word embedding as an entangled tensor via multiple small vectors. It essentially exploits Canonical Polyadic decomposition [16, 17]. Word2ketXs [27] is similar to Word2ket, but it compresses embeddings from the perspective of all words rather than individual words. In addition, KroneckerBERT [34] uses Kronecker decomposition to compress the word embeddings, and the form of Kronecker Embeddings is consistent with Word2ket [27] with an order of 2. Unlike these compression methods, our MorphTE utilizes meaningful morphemes as basic units for generating word embeddings, rather than vectors or tensors with no specific meaning.

3 Preliminary

3.1 Tensor Product Space and Entangled Tensors

A tensor product space of two separable Hilbert spaces $\mathcal{V}$ and $\mathcal{W}$ is also a separable Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}$, which is denoted as $\mathcal{H} = \mathcal{V} \otimes \mathcal{W}$. Suppose $\{\psi_1, \ldots, \psi_g\}$ and $\{\phi_1, \ldots, \phi_h\}$ are the orthonormal basis in $\mathcal{V}$ and $\mathcal{W}$, respectively. The tensor product of the vector $c = \sum_{j=1}^{g} c_j \psi_j \in \mathcal{V}$ and $e = \sum_{k=1}^{h} e_k \phi_k \in \mathcal{W}$ is defined as follow:

$$c \otimes e = \left\{ \sum_{j=1}^{g} c_j \psi_j \right\} \otimes \left\{ \sum_{k=1}^{h} e_k \phi_k \right\} = \sum_{j=1}^{g} \sum_{k=1}^{h} c_j e_k \psi_j \otimes \phi_k \tag{1}$$

The set $\{\psi_j \otimes \phi_k\}_{jk}$ forms the orthonormal basis in $\mathcal{H}$, and the dimensionality of $\mathcal{H}$ is the product (gh) of dimensionalities of $\mathcal{V}$ and $\mathcal{W}$. This tensor product operation can be simplified as the product of the corresponding coefficients as follow:

$$\begin{aligned} c \otimes e &= [c_1, c_2, \ldots, c_g] \otimes [e_1, e_2, \ldots, e_h] \\ &= [\underline{c_1 e_1, c_1 e_2, \ldots, c_1 e_h}, \ldots, \underline{c_g e_1, c_g e_2, \ldots, c_g e_h}] \end{aligned} \tag{2}$$

The cumulative tensor product space of the following form is said to have a tensor **order** of n, and the dimensionality of cumulative tensor product space is the cumulative product of its subspace dimensionalities. See Appendix B for concrete examples of the cumulative tensor product of multiple vectors.

$$\bigotimes_{j=1}^{n} \mathcal{H} = \mathcal{H}_1 \otimes \mathcal{H}_2 \ldots \otimes \mathcal{H}_n \tag{3}$$

Considering the n-order tensor product space $\bigotimes_{j=1}^{n} \mathcal{H}_j$, vectors of the form $v = \otimes_{j=1}^{n} v_j$, where $v_j \in \mathcal{H}_j$, are called **simple tensors**. In addition, vectors need to be represented as the sum of multiple

simple tensors are called **entangled tensors**. Tensor **rank** of a vector v is the smallest number of simple tensors that sum up to v.

3.2 Tensorized Embeddings with Tensor Product

Tensor products have been introduced to learn parameter-efficient word embeddings in KroneckerBERT [34] and Word2ket[27]. As shown in Figure 2, Word2ket[27] represents the embedding $v \in \mathbb{R}^d$ of a word as an entangled tensor of rank r and order n as follow:

$$v = \sum_{k=1}^{r} \bigotimes_{j=1}^{n} v_{jk} \tag{4}$$

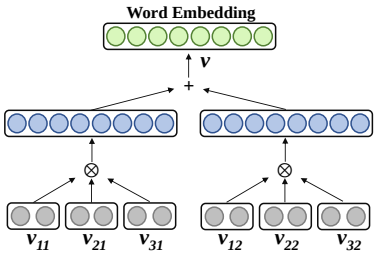

Figure 2: Word2ket embedding with a rank of $r = 2$ and an order of $n = 3$.

where $v_{jk} \in \mathbb{R}^q$ and $v \in \mathbb{R}^{q^n}$. Word2ket only needs to store and use these small vectors v_{jk} to generate a large word embedding. If $q^n > d$, the excess part of the generated embedding will be cut off. Therefore, setting $q^n = d$ can avoid the waste of parameters caused by clipping, and the number of embedding parameters for a word is reduced from d to $rn\sqrt[n]{d}$. For example, when $d = 512$, $q = 8$, $n = 3$, and $r = 2$, the number of parameters of a word embedding can be reduced from 512 to 48.

4 Methodology: Morphologically-enhanced Tensorized Embeddings

In this section, we first discuss the rationale for introducing morphology in the embedding compression. Then, we propose **MorphTE**, a morphologically-enhanced word embedding compression method based on the tensor product. Finally, we show the detailed workflow of MorphTE.

4.1 Motivation to Introduce Morphology

To achieve compression, existing decomposition-based word embedding compression methods [18, 15] use a series of small vectors or tensors to generate large word embeddings, as shown in Figure 2. These methods are not only uninterpretable as their small tensors do not have specific meaning [15, 27], but also lack lexical knowledge. We argue that, in resource-limited scenarios like compression, knowledge injection is much more critical than in common scenarios. Since with a significant amount of parameters in common scenarios it could to an easier extent learn implicitly such knowledge in a data-driven way, which is also one of the objectives for neural networks. However, in compression, it is more beneficial to inject explicit knowledge to compensate for inferiority in parameter scales, therefore underscoring *the importance of knowledge injection in compression*.

From a *reductionism* point of view, words might not be the smallest unit for some languages; for example `unfeelingly` could be separated into four meaningful parts [`un`, `feel`, `ing`, `ly`], a.k.a., morphemes [2]. By using a limited number of morphemes, one could possibly exponentially extend a given core vocabulary by composing morphemes as new words according to the rules of word formation in Table 1. The adoption of morphemes largely reduces the memory burden and therefore facilitates the learning of words for humans. We hypothesize that morphology also helps for word representation in neural networks, especially in resource-limited scenarios like compression.

4.2 Definition of MorphTE

Considering the above analysis, we propose to inject morphological knowledge to achieve high-quality and space-efficient word embeddings. Suppose a word is segmented as l morphemes $[m_1, m_2, \ldots, m_l]$ in the natural order. For example, a four-morpheme word `unfeelingly` is segmented as [`un`, `feel`, `ing`, `ly`]. We refer $f_1(\cdot), f_2(\cdot), \cdots f_r(\cdot) : \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{R}^q$ as r different *representation functions* of morphemes [3], selected from a parametric family $\mathcal{F} = \{f : \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{R}^q\}$. The

[2] This also holds for *logogram*, written symbols of which represent words instead of sounds. For example, Chinese language has character components, a.k.a, radicals.

[3] For example, such a function could be morpheme embeddings, each vector of which is a q-sized vector, which are similar to word embeddings.

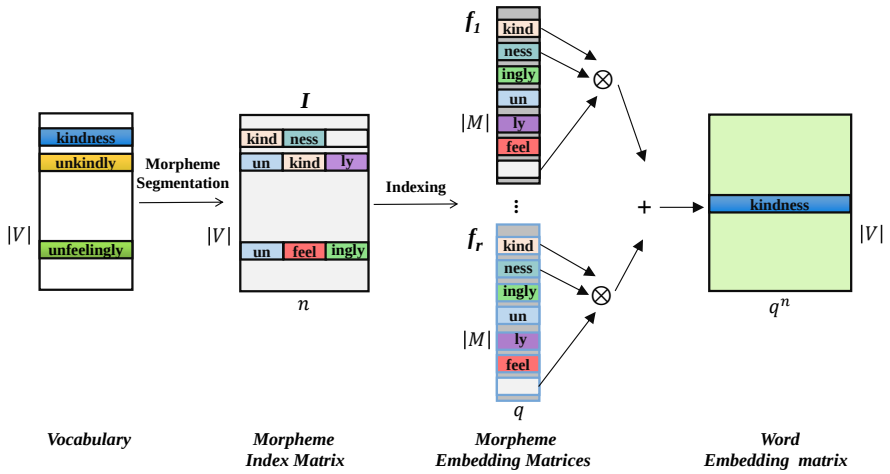

Figure 3: The workflow of MorphTE. $\boldsymbol{n}$ is the order (number of morphemes for a word). $\boldsymbol{q}$ is the size of morpheme vectors. $|\boldsymbol{V}|$ and $|\boldsymbol{M}|$ denote the size of word vocabulary and morpheme vocabulary.

Morphologically-enhanced Tensorized Embedding (MorphTE in short) of a word is defined as a sum of cumulative tensor products of morpheme vectors from different representation functions, namely,

$$v = \sum_{i=1}^{r} \bigotimes_{j=1}^{l} f_i(m_j) \tag{5}$$

Each representation function of morphemes f_i could sometimes be considered as a subspace of morphemes. The number of subspaces (i.e., r) is called the **rank**, and the number of morphemes (i.e., n) of a word is called the **order**, similar to Word2ket. The sum of the outputs from different subspaces in MorphTE is similar to the multi-head mechanism in Transformer [37].

Reasons to use tensor product. MorphTE utilizes tensor products to aggregate several small vectors Interestingly, we find that there are some commonalities between tensor product and morpheme composition. **(1)** Both tensor product and morpheme composition are non-commutative (e.g., $c \otimes e \neq e \otimes c$ and likewise "houseboat" $\neq$ "boathouse"). **(2)** Small vectors are the smallest units in Word2ket and morphemes are also the smallest meaning-bearing units of words. Naturally, these small vectors in Word2ket can be assigned morpheme identities and shared among different words.

4.3 Workflow of MorphTE

We describe the workflow of MorphTE to generate embeddings for all the words in Figure 3.

Morpheme segmentation Suppose there are $|V|$ individual words. We first segment each word as a sequence of morphemes (a l-morpheme word could be segmented as a sequence as $[m_1, \ldots, m_l]$) using polyglot [4] To facilitate processing in neural networks, we truncate morpheme sequences in a fixed length n (e.g., $n = 3$ or $n = 4$). **(1)** For those words that have less than n morphemes, we pad them with some extra tokens; for example, we pad a single-morpheme word with $n - 1$ padding morphemes. **(2)** For those words that have more than n morphemes, we concatenate the rest of morphemes as the last one. The processing could be explained as follows:

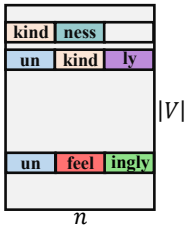

Figure 4: Segmentation

$$\begin{cases} [m_1, m_2, \ldots, m_l, \text{pad}_{l+1}, \ldots \text{pad}_n], & l < n \\ [m_1, m_2, \ldots, \text{concat}(m_n, \ldots, m_l)], & l > n \end{cases} \tag{6}$$

[4] polyglot could be found in `https://github.com/aboSamoor/polyglot`. Based on morfessor [38], polyglot provides trained morpheme segmentation models for a variety of languages. Numerous studies [3, 29, 12] also utilize morfessor for morpheme segmentation.

where concat$(\cdot)$ is the operation to concatenate multiple morphemes into one morpheme. For example, a four-morpheme word `unfeelingly`, segmented as [`un`, `feel`, **ing**, **ly**], could be then truncated into [`un`, `feel`, **ingly**] when $n = 3$.

After morpheme segmentation, we could get a n-length morpheme sequence for each word; this results in a matrix $I \in \mathbb{R}^{|V| \times n}$, each row of which (denoted as $I_j \in \mathbb{R}^n$) is the morpheme sequence for a word (i.e., w_j), see I in Figure 4.

Rank-one MorphTE Assume that there are $|M|$ individual morphemes. We first define a q-sized trainable morpheme embeddings $f \in \mathbb{R}^{|M| \times q}$. For a word w_j with a morpheme sequence $[I_{j,1}, I_{j,2}, \cdots, I_{j,n}]$, its rank-one MorphTE embedding is a tensor product between these q-sized embeddings of these morphemes, resulting in a q^n-sized vector. Namely, the formula for a rank-one version of MorphTE is as follows:

$$\text{Embed}(w_j) = f(I_{j,1}) \otimes f(I_{j,2}) \otimes \ldots \otimes f(I_{j,n}) \tag{7}$$

If q^n is greater than the given dimensionality of word embeddings (i.e., d), the excess part of the generated word embedding will be discarded.

General MorphTE Here, we propose a general version of MorphTE; the rank-one MorphTE is a special case of MorphTE when its rank $r = 1$. We define r copies of morpheme embeddings, namely, $f_1, \ldots, f_r \in \mathbb{R}^{|M| \times q}$ with Xavier [13]. The general MorphTE could be considered as a sum of r rank-one MorphTE embeddings, r is called a 'rank' of MorphTE. Technically, it is formalized as:

$$\text{Embed}(w_j) = \sum_{i=1}^{r} f_i(I_{j,1}) \otimes \ldots \otimes f_i(I_{j,n}) \tag{8}$$

4.4 Difference between MorphTE and Word2ket

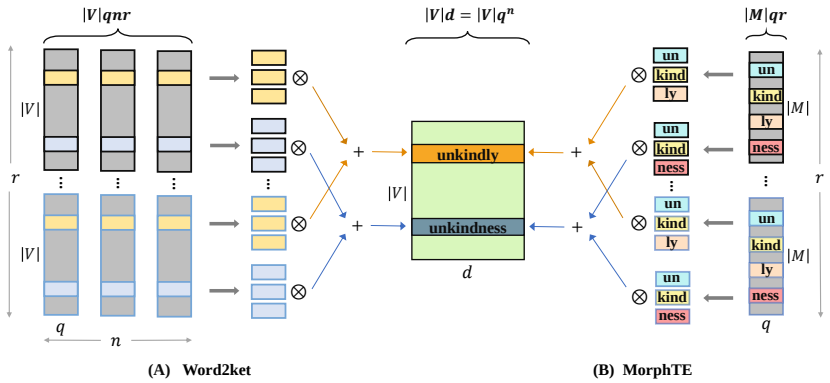

Figure 5: The graphical representation and parameters of Word2ket (A), and MorphTE (B). We show the procedure of how Word2ket and MorphTE generate word embeddings. $|\boldsymbol{V}|$ and $|\boldsymbol{M}|$ denote the size of word vocabulary and morpheme vocabulary. $\boldsymbol{d}$ indicates the word embedding size and $\boldsymbol{q}$ indicates the size of the small vector in Word2ket and MorphTE. $\boldsymbol{r}$ is the rank and $\boldsymbol{n}$ is the order.

Although Eq. 5 of MorphTE and Eq. 4 of Word2ket have a similar form, these two methods are fundamentally different. Compared with Word2ket, the innovations of MorphTE are as follows:

MorphTE is morphologically-enhanced. MorphTE uses morpheme vectors with meaning or grammatical functions to generate word embeddings. Compared with vectors without specific meanings in Word2ket, this way introduces prior morphological knowledge and has better interpretability.

MorphTE captures commonness among words. MorphTE can explicitly add connections of morphologically similar words by sharing morpheme vectors. As shown in Figure 5, in MorphTE, "unkindly" and "unkindness" share the vectors of "un" and "kind", and they are both semantically related to "unkind". However, Word2ket considers these two words to be completely unrelated.

MorphTE is more parameter-efficient. Suppose MorphTE and Word2ket have the same rank ($r \geq 1$), order ($n \geq 2$), and dimensionality (q) of the subspace. **(1)** As shown in Figure 5, the number

of trainable parameters required by MorphTE and Word2ket are $|M|qr$ and $|V|qnr$, respectively. **(2)** The number of parameters of Word2ket divided by that of MorphTE equals $n|V|/|M|$. **(3)** As smaller units, the number of morphemes ($|M|$) is usually smaller than the number of words ($|V|$). Referring to Table 5, $|V|/|M| > 2.5$. **(4)** Hence, MorphTE can save more than 5 times the parameters compared to Word2ket ($n|V|/|M| > 2.5n \geq 5$).

5 Experiments

5.1 Experimental Setup

Baselines. **(1)** For word embedding compression, we chose **Matrix Factor.** (low–rank matrix factorization [18]), **Tensor Train** [15], **Word2ket**, and **Word2ketXs** embeddings [27] for comparison. **(2)** For morphological word embeddings, we reproduced the method (called as **MorphSum**) of representing a word embedding as the sum of its morpheme and surface form vectors [5, 29, 2]. In addition, we reproduced the method (called as **MorphLSTM**) of using the output of the word's last morpheme in the LSTM network [14] as the embedding of the word, referring to Morphological RNNs [5]. Our MorphTE utilizes the same morpheme segmentation as MorphSum and MorphLSTM. Besides, we call the original word embeddings as **Original**. Except for the embedding layer, all models have the same structure.

Tasks, Datasets, and Metrics. We conducted experiments on machine translation, question answering, and natural language inference (NLI) tasks. **(1)** For machine translation tasks, we chose IWSLT'14 German-to-English (De-En) dataset [7], English-to-Italian (En-It), English-to-Spanish (En-Es), and English-to-Russian (En-Ru) datasets of OPUS-100 [42]. The De-En dataset contains 160K sentence pairs and is processed by the BPE [31] of 10K tokens. The En-It, En-Es, and En-Ru datasets contain 1M sentence pairs and use joint source-target vocabulary processed by the BPE of 40K tokens. The performance is measured by case-sensitive tokenized *BLEU*[28] for all translation tasks. **(2)** For question answering tasks, we chose *WikiQA* [40], a retrieval-based question answering dataset. It contains 20.4K training pairs, and *mean average precision* (*MAP*), *mean reciprocal rank* (*MRR*) are used for evaluation. **(3)** For NLI tasks, we chose *SNLI* [6] which consists of 570k annotated sentence pairs from an image captioning corpus. *Accuracy* is used as the evaluation metric.

Implementations. **(1)** For machine translation tasks, we chose Transformer [37] with the implementation of Fairseq [26]. For De-En dataset, the Transformer consists of 6-layer encoder and 6-layer decoder with 512 embedding size, 1024 feed-forward network (FFN) size. It is trained with a batch size of 4096 tokens on a NVIDIA Tesla V100 GPU. For En-It, En-Es, and En-Ru tasks, the FFN size is increased to 2048. They are trained with a batch size of 32768 tokens on 2 NVIDIA Tesla V100 GPUs. **(2)** For question answering and NLI tasks, we followed the implementation and setup of RE2 [39]. The word embedding size is set to 512, and we trained them for 30 epochs with the early stopping. **(3)** Notices: Unless otherwise specified, the hyperparameter *order* of MorphTE is 3 in our experiments. For MorphTE and word embedding compression baselines, they are compared under a roughly equal number of parameters (compression ratio) by adjusting their hyperparameters of the *rank*. For more details on hyperparameters and training settings, refer to Appendix D.

5.2 Main Results

MorphTE outperforms compression baselines. As shown in Table 2, we compared MorphTE and compression baselines at about $20\times$ and $40\times$ compression ratios on four translation datasets. **(1)** At the ratio of $20\times$, MorphTE can maintain the performance of the original embeddings on all datasets. Specifically, MorphTE achieves 0.4 and 0.3 BLEU score improvements on the De-En and En-Ru datasets, respectively. For other datasets, it achieves the same BLEU scores. However, none of the other compression methods can maintain the performance of the original model on these datasets. **(2)** At the ratio of $40\times$, although almost all compression methods cannot maintain the original performance, MorphTE still achieves the best results compared to other compression baselines. Notably, the performance of the Matrix Factor. degrades significantly when a higher compression is conducted, and Word2ket cannot achieve more than $40\times$ compression on these datasets.

Table 2: Experimental results of different embedding compression methods on translation tasks. **BLEU scores** and **compression ratios** of the embedding layers are reported, with the form of B(C×). - indicates that the method can not achieve approximately the same compression ratio as other methods. Refer to Appendix C for the analysis of the parameters of the methods.

Method	De-En		En-It		En-Es		En-Ru	
Original	34.5 (1.0×)	-	**32.9** (1.0×)	-	**39.1** (1.0×)	-	31.6 (1.0×)	-
Matrix Factor.	32.7 (19×)	22.8 (40×)	31.0 (20×)	23.2 (42×)	38.0 (20×)	29.7 (42×)	28.9 (20×)	17.9 (40×)
Tensor Train	34.3 (20×)	33.4 (43×)	32.4 (21×)	**32.1** (43×)	38.7 (21×)	38.5 (43×)	31.2 (21×)	30.9 (41×)
Word2ketXs	34.3 (21×)	33.7 (42×)	32.6 (21×)	31.5 (43×)	38.4 (21×)	38.0 (43×)	31.5 (21×)	31.0 (41×)
Word2ket	34.2 (21×)	-	32.3 (21×)	-	**39.1** (21×)	-	31.3 (21×)	-
MorphTE	**34.9** (**21**×)	**34.1** (43×)	**32.9** (21×)	**32.1** (45×)	**39.1** (21×)	**38.7** (43×)	**31.9** (21×)	**31.5** (41×)

MorphTE can handle different languages and tasks well. (1) We validated MorphTE on translation datasets of De-En, En-It, En-Es, and En-Ru. MorphTE has been shown to handle different languages effectively. **(2)** For translation tasks, the De-En dataset uses separate source and target dictionaries, while other datasets use a shared source-target dictionary. MorphTE is shown to work in both ways. **(3)** Besides translation tasks, we also validated MorphTE on question answering (WikiQA) and natural language inference (SNLI) tasks. The experimental results in Table 3 show that MorphTE still maintains the performance of the original model and outperforms other compression baselines on these different tasks.

Table 3: Experimental results on WikiQA of question answering tasks and SNLI of NLI tasks. ratio means the compression ratio of embedding layers.

Method	WikiQA			SNLI	
	ratio	MAP	MRR	ratio	Accuracy
Original	1×	0.6798	0.6970	1×	0.8492
Matrix Factor.	82×	0.5957	0.6121	38×	0.4166
Tensor Train	80×	0.6251	0.6440	37×	0.8473
Word2ketXs	80×	0.6686	0.6871	38×	0.8450
Word2ket	21×	**0.6842**	0.7025	21×	0.8487
MorphTE	81×	0.6834	**0.7051**	38×	**0.8497**

Table 4: Experimental results for analyzing the effect of morphology. **BLEU scores** and **compression ratios** of the embedding layers are reported, with the form of B(C×). **Morph.** indicates whether the method introduces morphological knowledge. **Compr.** indicates whether the method supports high compression. **Word2ket+Rshare** means the method of random sharing of small vectors in Word2ket.

Method	Morph.	Compr.	De-En	En-It	En-Es	En-Ru
Original	✗	✗	34.5 (1.0×)	**32.9** (1.0×)	39.1 (1.0×)	31.6 (1.0×)
MorphSum	✓	✗	**34.9** (0.7×)	**33.0** (0.8×)	39.1(0.8×)	31.7 (0.8×)
MorphLSTM	✓	✗	**34.9** (1.6×)	**32.9** (2.8×)	**39.7** (2.7×)	**32.4** (2.5×)
Word2ket	✗	✓	34.2 (21×)	32.3 (21×)	39.1 (21×)	31.3 (21×)
Word2ket+Rshare	✗	✓	34.0 (21×)	32.0 (21×)	38.3 (21×)	30.6 (21×)
MorphTE	✓	✓	**34.9** (21×)	**32.9** (21×)	39.1 (21×)	31.9 (21×)

Morpheme-based morphology can enhance word embeddings. To study the impact of morphemes on MorphTE, we conducted following explorations. **(1)** As introduced in Section 5.1, MorphSum and MorphLSTM both introduce morphological knowledge based on morphemes. As shown in Table 4, although they cannot achieve high compression on word embeddings, they (especially MorphLSTM) achieve significant improvements compared with original embeddings. This shows that morphological knowledge based on morphemes is beneficial for word embeddings. **(2)** MorphTE assigns the identities of morphemes to the small vectors of Word2ket, and shares these small vectors based on morphemes. We consider the method (called Word2ket+Rshare) of random sharing of small vectors in Word2ket rather than morpheme-based sharing. This method can be implemented in such a way that for each word, randomly assign several row vectors of the trainable matrix of the same shape as the morpheme embedding matrix. As shown in Table 4, Word2ket+Rshare has lower BLEU scores than Word2ket on different translation datasets, and it is significantly inferior to MorphTE. This also verifies that it makes sense to introduce morphemes in MorphTE.

Marginal utility of higher compression ratios (e.g., > 40). We report the statistics of translation tasks in Table 5. The experimental results of this table are consistent with those in Table 2. **(1)** At about $20\times$ compression, MorphTE can maintain the performance of the original word embeddings.

Table 5: Statistics of translation tasks. $|V|$ and $|M|$ are the size of the word vocabulary and morpheme vocabulary, respectively. #Struc and #Emb are the number of parameters of the model structure and that of the embedding layer, respectively. ratio is the compression ratio of the word embedding layer. P is the proportion of the embedding layer to the total parameters.

Dataset	$\|V\|$	$\|M\|$	#Struc	Original		MorphTE							
				#Emb	P	ratio	#Emb	P	Δ BLEU	ratio	#Emb	P	Δ BLEU
De-En	15480	5757	31.54M	7.93M	20.1%	21×	0.37M	1.2%	+ 0.4	43×	0.18M	0.6%	− 0.4
En-It	41280	10818	44.14M	21.14M	32.4%	21×	0.99M	2.2%	+ 0.0	45×	0.45M	1.0%	− 0.8
En-Es	41336	11377	44.14M	21.16M	32.4%	21×	1.03M	2.3%	+ 0.0	43×	0.49M	1.1%	− 0.4
En-Ru	42000	12423	44.14M	21.50M	32.8%	21×	1.02M	2.3%	+ 0.3	41×	0.52M	1.2%	− 0.1

The number of embedding parameters is approximately reduced from 20M to 1M, and its proportion of total parameters is reduced from 20.1%-31.8% to 1.2%-2.3%. **(2)** At about 40× compression, although MorphTE outperforms other compression methods referring to Table 2, MorphTE's BLEU scores are significantly lower than the original model. Although the compression ratio is increased from 20× to 40×, the parameters of embeddings are only approximately reduced from 1M to 0.5M, and the proportion of embedding parameters to the total parameters is only reduced from 1.2%-2.3% to 0.6%-1.2%. Considering the loss of model performance, the slight reduction in the number of parameters resulting from higher compression ratios does not make much sense.

5.3 Ablation Study

Sensitivity on the *order*. **(1)** In previous experiments, we set the order of MorphTE to 3. In this section, we perform the statistical analysis and ablation experiments on the De-En dataset. Morpheme statistics show that more than 90% of the words have no more than three morphemes, referring to Appendix E. **(2)** We set the order of MorphTE to 2, 3, and 4, that is, limiting the maximum number of morphemes to 2, 3, and 4, respectively. The word embedding size was set to 512. We adjusted the rank of MorphTE so that the models corresponding to these three cases have a similar number of parameters. From Table 6, setting the order of MorphTE to 3 achieves the best results when compressing the word embedding parameters by about 20 times.

Table 6: Experimental results for the ablation on the order of MorphTE on De-En. **d / q** means the size of the word embedding or morpheme vector. **|V| / |M|** means the size of the word or morpheme vocabulary.

Method	order	rank	d / q	|V| / |M|	#Emb	ratio	BLEU
Orginal	-	-	512	15480	7.93M	1x	34.5
MorphTE	2	2	23	7654	0.38M	20x	34.4
	3	7	8	5757	0.37M	21x	**34.9**
	4	11	6	5257	0.41M	19x	34.4

Sensitivity on the *rank*. We show the effect of *rank* on the number of parameters and performance of MorphTE in Figure 6. The *rank* of MorphTE is set from 1 to 32. As can be seen, as the *rank* increases, the number of embedding parameters increases linearly, and the Accuracy first increases and then gradually stabilizes. This means that with the increase of embedding parameters, the model performance will gradually improve, but after the parameter amount exceeds a certain threshold, it will not drive the performance improvement. Therefore, the degree of compression and model performance can be balanced by adjusting the *rank* of MorphTE.

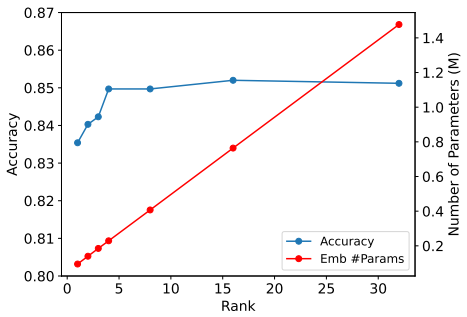

Figure 6: Accuracy on SNLI and parameter numbers of embeddings changes w.r.t. the rank.

Sensitivity on the *Embedding Size*. To verify that MorphTE can stably achieve compression under different word embedding dimensionalities, We conducted experiments with the dimensionalities of 216, 512, and 1000. As can be seen in Table 7, when order $n = 3$ and the word embedding size / hidden size (d) is set to 216, 512, and 1000, the dimensionality of the morpheme vector (q) is set to 6, 8, and 10, respectively. In addition, the rank is set to 8 for these three cases. It can be seen that as the

dimensionality of a word embedding increases significantly, the dimensionality of the morpheme vector does not increase significantly. This means that the larger the word embedding size, the more the compression potential of our method can be released. Specifically, when the word embedding dimensionality is 216, our method can compress the word embedding parameters by a factor of 10 with comparable model performance. When the word embedding dimensionality is set to 512, our method is able to compress the word embedding parameters by a factor of 19, with a 0.4 BLEU score higher than the uncompressed model. When the word embedding dimensionality is set to 1000, our method outperforms the original model by a 0.6 BLEU score when compressing the word embedding parameters by a factor of 30. In conclusion, our method has stable compression ability and can maintain or slightly improve the model performance under different word embedding sizes.

Table 7: Experimental results for the ablation on the embedding size on IWSLT'14 De-En. d/q means the size of the word embedding or morpheme vector. $|V|/|M|$ means the size of the word or morpheme vocabulary. n and r are the order and rank of MorphTE. **#Emb** and **#Stuc** are the parameter numbers of the embedding layer and the model structure, respectively. **ratio** is the compression ratio of word embedding layers.

Method	d/q	n	r	$\|V\|/\|M\|$	**#Emb**	**ratio**	**#Stuc**	**BLEU**
Original	216	3	-	15480	3.34M	1×	8.71M	34.1
MorphTE	6	3	8	5757	0.32M	10×	8.71M	**34.2**
Original	512	3	-	15480	7.93M	1×	31.54M	34.5
MorphTE	8	3	8	5757	0.41M	19×	31.54M	**34.9**
Original	1000	3	-	15480	15.48M	1×	96.72M	32.8
MorphTE	10	3	8	5757	0.51M	30×	96.72M	**33.4**

Similar to other compression methods, our method introduces some computational overhead when generating word embeddings. However, this limitation is light according to the experimental analysis in Appendix G.

6 Conclusion

We propose MorphTE which combines the prior knowledge of morphology and the compression ability of tensor products to learn high-quality and space-efficient word embeddings. We validated our method on tasks such as machine translation, text summarization, and retrieval-based question answering. Experimental results show that MorphTE can handle different languages and tasks well. It outperforms related decomposition-based word embedding compression methods such as Word2ket [27] and TT embeddings [15], and can achieve dozens of times compression of word embedding parameters without hurting the performance of the original model.

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   (a) Do the main claims made in the abstract and introduction accurately reflect the paper's contributions and scope? [Yes]
   (b) Did you describe the limitations of your work? [No]
   (c) Did you discuss any potential negative societal impacts of your work? [No]
   (d) Have you read the ethics review guidelines and ensured that your paper conforms to them? [Yes]
2. If you are including theoretical results...
   (a) Did you state the full set of assumptions of all theoretical results? [N/A]
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3. If you ran experiments...
   (a) Did you include the code, data, and instructions needed to reproduce the main experimental results (either in the supplemental material or as a URL)? [Yes] See supplemental material.
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   (a) Did you include the full text of instructions given to participants and screenshots, if applicable? [N/A]
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A Linguistic Phenomena in Word Formation

In the theory of linguistic morphology, morphemes are considered to be the smallest meaning-bearing or grammatical units of a language.

In the word formation, common linguistic phenomena include inflection, derivation, and compounding, as shown in Table 1 of our paper. **(1)** Inflection occurs when a word has different forms but essentially the same meaning. For example, the underlying meanings of ‘`cooks`‘, ‘`cooked`‘, and ‘`cooking`‘ are all ‘`cook`‘, and there are only certain grammatical differences. **(2)** Derivation makes a word with a different meaning, such as ‘`possible`‘ and ‘`impossible`‘. **(3)** Compounding occurs when multiple words are combined to form a new word. For example, ‘`policeman`‘ is obtained by compounding ‘`police`‘ and ‘`man`‘. Based on these common phenomena, there are common connections between words due to shared morphemes, and morphologically similar words with some of the same morphemes are often semantically related. Therefore, it makes sense to segment words into morphemes to learn word representations in a more fine-grained way.

B The Example of Tensor Products

Typically, there exist two types of definitions for the tensor product. Here, we give an example for the tensor product between two vectors, but it also holds for the tensor product between matrices.

Definition 1. a tensor product between an m-sized vector and an n-sized vector results in an $m \times n$ matrix.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{a} \otimes^1 \mathbf{b} &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 \\ a_2 \end{bmatrix} \otimes \begin{bmatrix} b_1 & b_2 & b_3 \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 b_1 & a_1 b_2 & a_1 b_3 \\ a_2 b_1 & a_2 b_2 & a_2 b_3 \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned} \tag{9}$$

Definition 2. a tensor product between an m-sized vector and an n-sized vector results in an mn-sized vector.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{a} \otimes^2 \mathbf{b} &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 & a_2 \end{bmatrix} \otimes \begin{bmatrix} b_1 & b_2 & b_3 \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 \begin{bmatrix} b_1 & b_2 & b_3 \end{bmatrix} & a_2 \begin{bmatrix} b_1 & b_2 & b_3 \end{bmatrix} \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 b_1 & a_1 b_2 & a_1 b_3 & a_2 b_1 & a_2 b_2 & a_2 b_3 \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned} \tag{10}$$

Note that Definition 1 increases the dimensions of the tensors while Definition 2 does not. As formulated in Eq. 2 in our paper, we use Definition 2 without dimension increase if not specified. The difference between Definition 1 and Definition 2 is that Definition 2 further **reshapes** the RHS of Definition 1 (previously a two-dimensional tensor, i.e., a matrix) into a flattened vector. Since a word embedding is a vector in neural networks, we make use of Definition 2 so that any resulted embeddings for words are necessarily vectors.

As formulated in Eq. 2, a tensor product between a g-sized vector and h-sized vector results in a gh-sized vector. Similarly, a cumulative tensor product of n q-size vectors will be a q^n-sized vector. We show a concrete example of cumulative tensor product with $n = 3$ and $q = 2$ as follow:

$$\begin{aligned} &\mathbf{a} \otimes \mathbf{b} \otimes \mathbf{c} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 & a_2 \end{bmatrix} \otimes \begin{bmatrix} b_1 & b_2 \end{bmatrix} \otimes \begin{bmatrix} c_1 & c_2 \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 \begin{bmatrix} b_1 & b_2 \end{bmatrix} & a_2 \begin{bmatrix} b_1 & b_2 \end{bmatrix} \end{bmatrix} \otimes \begin{bmatrix} c_1 & c_2 \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 b_1 & a_1 b_2 & a_2 b_1 & a_2 b_2 \end{bmatrix} \otimes \begin{bmatrix} c_1 & c_2 \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 b_1 \begin{bmatrix} c_1 & c_2 \end{bmatrix} & a_1 b_2 \begin{bmatrix} c_1 & c_2 \end{bmatrix} & a_2 b_1 \begin{bmatrix} c_1 & c_2 \end{bmatrix} & a_2 b_2 \begin{bmatrix} c_1 & c_2 \end{bmatrix} \end{bmatrix} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} a_1 b_1 c_1 & a_1 b_1 c_2 & a_1 b_2 c_1 & a_1 b_2 c_2 & a_2 b_1 c_1 & a_2 b_1 c_2 & a_2 b_2 c_1 & a_2 b_2 c_2 \end{bmatrix} \end{aligned} \tag{11}$$

Table 8: Parameter complexities for different word embedding methods. $|V|$ and d are the word vocabulary size and word embedding size, respectively. r and n are the rank and order. $|M|$ is the morpheme vocabulary size.

Method	Parameter	**Method**	Parameter	**Method**	Parameter
Original	$\|V\|d$	Word2ket	$rn\|V\|\sqrt[n]{d}$	Word2ketXs	$rn\sqrt[n]{\|V\|}\sqrt[n]{d}$
MorphTE	$\|M\|\sqrt[n]{d}r+\|V\|n$	Matrix Factor.	$r\left(\|V\|+d\right)$	Tensor Train	$\left((n-2)r^2+2r\right)\sqrt[n]{\|V\|}\sqrt[n]{d}$
MorphSum	$\left(\|V\|+\|M\|\right)d$	MorphLSTM	$\|M\|d+8d^2$		

C Analysis of Parameter

In the experiments of the paper, we directly report the specific number of parameters for different word embedding methods. To illustrate how these parameter numbers are calculated, we report the parameter complexity and settings of different methods in Section C.1 and Section C.2, respectively.

C.1 Parameter Complexity of Embedding Methods

We summarize the parameter complexities of different embedding methods in Table 8. Suppose the **word vocabulary size** is $|V|$ and the **word embedding size** (dimensionality) is d. Suppose the **morpheme vocabulary size** is $|M|$, which involves embedding methods utilizing morphology. Suppose the **rank** is r and the **order** is n, which involves decomposition-based embedding compression methods. Note that the rank and order have different meanings in different decomposition methods. The value of the order is generally 2 to 4. The number of parameters of the decomposition method is generally controlled by adjusting the rank, and the value of rank may vary greatly in different methods. The detailed analysis of the parameter complexity is as follows:

- **Original**: The original word embedding layer has a word embedding matrix, each row of which is the embedding (vector) of a word. The parameter number of the embedding matrix is $|V|d$.
- **MorphSum**: MorphSum needs to specify a unique embedding for each morpheme and word, resulting in the parameter number of $\left(|V|+|M|\right)d$.
- **MorphLSTM**: MorphLSTM needs to specify a unique embedding for each morpheme, resulting in the parameter number of $|M|d$. In addition, the LSTM network in MorphLSTM requires $8d^2$ parameters. Therefore, the total parameter number is $|M|d+8d^2$.
- **Matrix Factor.**: The low–rank matrix factorization method decomposes the original word embedding matrix into the product of two small matrices of size $|V|\times r$ and $r\times d$. r is called the rank of this method. Therefore, the number of parameters required by this method is $r\left(|V|+d\right)$.
- **Word2ket**: Referring to Eq. 4 in the paper, Word2ket represents the embedding of a word as an entangled tensor of rank r and n. The number of parameters required by this method is at least $rn|V|\sqrt[n]{d}$.
- **Word2ketXs**: Word2ketXs compresses both the vocabulary size ($|V|$) and the word embedding size (d), while Word2ket only compresses the word embedding size **(**d**)** . The number of parameters required by this method is at least $rn\sqrt[n]{|V|}\sqrt[n]{d}$.
- **Tensor Train**: Like word2ketXS, Tensor Train method compresses both the vocabulary size ($|V|$) and the word embedding size (d). This method compresses the embedding matrix into 2 tensors of sizes $|V|_1\times d_1\times r$ and $|V|_n\times d_n\times r$, and $n-2$ tensors with size of $|V|_i\times d_i\times r^2$ $(1<i<n)$, where $|V|=\prod_{k=1}^{n}|V|_k$, and $d=\prod_{k=1}^{n}d_k$. To simplify the calculation, let $|V|_1=\ldots=|V|_n=\sqrt[n]{|V|}$ and $d_1=\ldots=d_n=\sqrt[n]{d}$, and then the number of parameters of this method is $\left((n-2)r^2+2r\right)\sqrt[n]{|V|}\sqrt[n]{d}$.
- **MorphTE**: Similar to Word2ket, the size of the morpheme vector is at least $\sqrt[n]{d}$. Referring to Section 4, there are r morpheme embedding matrices of size $|M|\sqrt[n]{d}$, resulting in $|M|\sqrt[n]{d}r$ trainable parameters. In addition, storing the morpheme index matrix also requires additional constant parameters of $|V|n$. Therefore, the total parameter number is $|M|\sqrt[n]{d}r+|V|n$.

C.2 Settings of Embedding Methods

We show detailed settings of different embedding methods on translation tasks in Tables 9 and 10, and these two tables correspond to Table 2 of the paper. We show detailed settings of different embedding methods on WikiQA of question answering tasks and SNLI of natural language inference tasks in Tables 11 and 12. These two tables correspond to Table 3 of the paper.

Table 9: Detailed settings of Original, Matrix Factor., and Tensor Train methods on translation tasks, corresponding to Table 2. **De**-En and De-**En** mean the settings of the source language (De) and target language (En), respectively. Since other datasets (e.g., En-It) use shared source-target dictionaries, only one set of settings is reported. $|V|$ is the size of the word vocabulary and d is the size (dimensionality) of a word embedding. #Emb is the parameter number of the word embedding layer. n and r are the order and rank of decomposition methods, respectively. $\Delta|V|$ and Δd are the decomposition of the word vocabulary size ($|V|$) and word embedding dimensionality (d) by the decomposition method, respectively. For example, in Wordket, Δd is $(8, 8, 8)$, because a word embedding is constructed from three ($n = 3$) 8-size vectors.

Dataset	**Original**			**Matrix Factor.**				**Tensor Train**						
	$\|V\|$	d	#Emb	20×		40×		n	$\Delta\|V\|$	Δd	20×		40×	
				r	#Emb	r	#Emb				r	#Emb	r	#Emb
De-En	8848	512	4.53M	25	0.23M	12	0.11M	3	(18,20,25)	(8,8,8)	34	0.20M	23	0.09M
De-**En**	6632	512	3.40M	25	0.19M	12	0.09M	3	(14,20,25)	(8,8,8)	34	0.19M	23	0.09M
En-It	41280	512	21.14M	25	1.04M	12	0.50M	3	(30,35,40)	(8,8,8)	59	1.01M	41	0.49M
En-Es	41336	512	21.16M	25	1.05M	12	0.50M	3	(30,35,40)	(8,8,8)	59	1.01M	41	0.49M
En-Ru	42000	512	21.50M	25	1.06M	12	0.51M	3	(30,35,40)	(8,8,8)	59	1.01M	43	0.54M

Table 10: Detailed settings of Word2ketXs, Word2ket, and MorphTE methods on translation tasks, corresponding to Table 2. $|M|$ is the size of the morpheme vocabulary. Refer to Table 9 for the meaning of other fields.

Dataset	**Word2ketXs**							**Word2ket**				**MorphTE**						
	n	$\Delta\|V\|$	Δd	20×		40×		n	Δd	20×		$\|M\|$	n	Δd	20×		40×	
				r	#Emb	r	#Emb			r	#Emb				r	#Emb	r	#Emb
De-En	2	(95,95)	(16,32)	44	0.20M	22	0.10M	3	(8,8,8)	1	0.21M	3013	3	(8,8,8)	7	0.20M	3	0.10M
De-**En**	2	(82,82)	(16,32)	44	0.17M	22	0.09M	3	(8,8,8)	1	0.16M	2744	3	(8,8,8)	7	0.17M	3	0.08M
En-It	2	(205,205)	(16,32)	104	1.02M	50	0.49M	3	(8,8,8)	1	0.99M	10818	3	(8,8,8)	10	0.99M	4	0.45M
En-Es	2	(205,205)	(16,32)	104	1.02M	50	0.49M	3	(8,8,8)	1	0.99M	11377	3	(8,8,8)	10	1.03M	4	0.49M
En-Ru	2	(205,205)	(16,32)	104	1.02M	53	0.52M	3	(8,8,8)	1	1.01M	12423	3	(8,8,8)	9	1.02M	4	0.52M

Table 11: Detailed settings of Original, Matrix Factor., and Tensor Train methods on WikiQA and SNLI tasks, corresponding to Table 3. Refer to Table 9 for the meaning of the fields in this table.

Dataset	**Original**			**Matrix Factor.**		**Tensor Train**				
	$\|V\|$	d	#Emb	r	#Emb	n	$\Delta\|V\|$	Δd	r	#Emb
WikiQA	12333	512	6.314M	6	0.077M	3	(20,25,26)	(8,8,8)	19	0.079M
SNLI	16936	512	8.671M	13	0.227M	3	(25,25,32)	(8,8,8)	33	0.233M

Table 12: Detailed settings of Word2ketXs, Word2ket, and MorphTE methods on WikiQA and SNLI tasks, corresponding to Table 3. $|M|$ is the size of the morpheme vocabulary. Refer to Table 9 for the meaning of the fields in this table.

Dataset	**Word2ketXs**					**Word2ket**				**MorphTE**				
	n	$\Delta\|V\|$	Δd	r	#Emb	n	Δd	r	#Emb	$\|M\|$	n	Δd	r	#Emb
WikiQA	3	(24,24,24)	(8,8,8)	137	0.079M	3	(8,8,8)	1	0.296M	5152	3	(8,8,8)	1	0.078M
SNLI	3	(8,29,73)	(8,8,8)	260	0.229M	3	(8,8,8)	1	0.406M	5572	3	(8,8,8)	4	0.229M

D Implementation and Training Details

In this section, we report the hyperparameter details of the experiments in our paper. The hyperparameter details of implementation and training on machine translation tasks are shown in Table 13. The hyperparameter details of implementation and training on question answering and natural language inference tasks are shown in Table 14.

Table 13: Hyperparameter details of implementation and training on translation tasks. IWSLT'14 means the De-En dataset, and OPUS-100 means the En-It, En-Es, and En-Ru datasets.

Hyperparameter	IWSLT'14	OPUS-100
num encoder layers	6	6
num decoder layers	6	6
embedding size	512	512
feed-forward size	1024	2048
attention heads	4	8
learning rate	5e-4	7e-4
label smoothing	0.1	0.1
max tokens per batch	4096	36864
dropout	0.3	0.25
Adam-betas	(0.9, 0.98)	(0.9, 0.98)
warmup steps	20000	20000
weight decay	0.0001	0.0
beam size	5	5

Table 14: Hyperparameter details of implementation and training on question answering and natural language inference tasks. QA means the question answering task of the WikiQA dataset, and NLI means the natural language inference task of the SNLI dataset.

Hyperparameter	QA	NLI
num encoder blocks	2	3
num convolutional encoders	3	2
kernel size	3	3
embedding size	512	512
hidden size	200	150
learning rate	1e-3	2e-3
batch size	400	512
dropout	0.1	0.1
Adam-betas	(0.9, 0.999)	(0.9, 0.999)
weight decay	0.0	0.0
lr decay rate	1.0	0.94

E Morpheme Statistics on IWSLT'14 De-En

We performed a statistical analysis of morphemes on the IWSLT'14 De-En dataset. The statistical results are shown in Table 15. The mor_∞ means the segmentation that does not limit the number of morphemes for a word. As can be seen from the row of Table 15 where mor_∞ is located, the number of words in German containing 1, 2, and 3 morphemes is 1728, 3623, and 2627, respectively. These words make up 91% of the total number of words (8848) in the corpus of German. In terms of English, the numbers of these three types of words are 1724, 2977, and 1632 respectively, accounting for a higher proportion (95%). Since most words contain no more than 3 morphemes, we tend to choose the segmentation that restricts the number of morphemes to a maximum of 3, and the order of MorphTE is set to 3.

Table 15: Statistics of morpheme segmentation results on IWSLT'14 De-En. The column of segmentation means different morphological segmentation schemes, mor_∞ means the segmentation that does not limit the number of morphemes for a word, and mor_i means the segmentation that restricts the number of morphemes to a maximum of i, referring to Eq. 6 in our paper. $N = n$ represents the number of words containing n morphemes. $|M|$ indicates the size of the morpheme vocabulary after the morpheme segmentation.

Language	segmentation	$\mathbf{N=1}$	$\mathbf{N=2}$	$\mathbf{N=3}$	$\mathbf{N=4}$	$\mathbf{N>4}$	$\mathbf{\lvert M\rvert}$
De (German)	mor_∞	1728	3623	2627	716	154	2531
	mor_4	1728	3623	2627	870	0	2643
	mor_3	1728	3623	3497	0	0	3013
	mor_2	1728	7120	0	0	0	4302
	mor_1	8848	0	0	0	0	8848
En (English)	mor_∞	1724	2977	1632	260	39	2584
	mor_4	1724	2977	1632	299	0	2614
	mor_3	1724	2977	1931	0	0	2744
	mor_2	1724	4908	0	0	0	3352
	mor_1	6632	0	0	0	0	6632

F Effect of Morpheme Segmenters on MorphTE

In previous experiments, our MorphTE utilized the morfessor [38] to segment words. It is a widely used morpheme segmentation tool [3, 29, 12]. In this section, we study how the morpheme segmenter affects the performance of MorphTE. We hypothesize that high-quality morpheme segmentation could improve the performance of MorphTE, while unreasonable segmentation could be counterproductive. To illustrate this, we add a comparative experiment on morpheme segmentation methods. Instead of using a morpheme segmenter, we design a random segmentation method called randomSeg. The randomseg does not segment words with a length of no more than three. For words with more than three characters, randomSeg randomly selects two gaps from the inside of the word to divide the word into 3 parts. Obviously, randomSeg makes little use of morpheme knowledge.

Table 16: Experimental results of different morpheme segmenters on translation tasks. Original dictates the original word embeddings without compression. MorphTE w/ morfessor dictates the MorphTE we use in the paper. MorphTE w/ randomSeg indicates the MorphTE using randomSeg for morpheme segmentation.

Method	De-En	En-It	En-Es	En-Ru
Original	34.5	32.9	39.1	31.6
MorphTE w/ morfessor	34.9	32.9	39.1	31.9
MorphTE w/ randomSeg	33.8	31.7	38.6	30.4

As shown in Table 16, the performance of MorphTE w/ randomSeg is inferior to the original word embedding method and MorphTE w/ morfessor on four translation datasets. This shows that morpheme segmentation can affect the effectiveness of MorphTE, and improving morpheme segmentation may further enhance MorphTE.

G Memory and Time Analysis

G.1 Memory Analysis

Table 17: Experimental results of the memory cost for different embedding methods. #Emb represents the memory/parameter cost of the word embedding layer, and #Stuc represents the memory/parameter cost of other parts of the model except the word embedding layer. P represents the proportion of the memory/parameter cost of the word embedding layer to the total cost of the model.

Method	Parameter			Memory		
	#Stuc/ M	#Emb / M	P / %	#Stuc / MiB	#Emb / MiB	P / %
Original	3.8	6.3	62	14.6	24.1	62
Matrix Factor.	3.8	0.08	2	14.6	0.3	2
Tensor Train	3.8	0.08	2	14.6	0.3	2
Word2ketXS	3.8	0.08	2	14.6	0.3	2
Word2ket	3.8	0.3	7	14.6	1.1	7
MorphTE	3.8	0.08	2	14.6	0.3	2

Through MorphTE or other compression methods, the parameters of the word embedding layer can be greatly reduced. In this section, We further experimentally test the memory cost of different word embedding methods on the WikiQA task. The experimental setup is consistent with the main experiment in our paper. As shown in Table 17, the memory reduction of different word embedding compression methods is consistent with their parameter reduction. MorphTE could reduce the proportion of the original word embedding parameters/memory to the total model parameters/memory from about 62% to 2%.

G.2 Time Analysis

Table 18: Experimental results of the time cost for different embedding methods. #Emb represents the time cost of the word embedding layer, and #Stuc represents the time cost of other parts of the model except the word embedding layer. P represents the proportion of the time cost of the word embedding layer to the total time cost of the model.

Method	GPU			CPU		
	#Stuc / ms	#Emb / ms	P / %	#Stuc / ms	#Emb / ms	P / %
Original	10.6	0.1	0.9	92.0	0.1	0.1
Matrix Factor.	10.6	0.2	1.9	92.0	1.0	1.1
Tensor Train	10.6	0.5	4.5	92.0	45.0	33
Word2ketXS	10.6	0.6	5.4	92.0	49.0	35
Word2ket	10.6	0.5	4.5	92.0	2.0	2.1
MorphTE	10.6	0.6	5.4	92.0	3.0	3.2

The original word embedding method can directly index the word vector from the word embedding matrix, and this process has almost no computational overhead. Almost all word embedding compression methods, including our method, require certain pre-operations to generate word embeddings, which introduces a certain computational overhead. To this end, we test the time cost of different word embedding methods on the WikiQA task. The experimental setup is also consistent with the main experiment in our paper. We test the time cost of different word embedding methods on Intel E5-2698 CPU and Tesla V100 GPU. Specifically, we repeat the test 100 times on an input sample, and average the time.

As shown in Table 18, although word embedding compression methods increase the time cost of word embeddings, most of them only account for a small fraction of the total time cost. The time cost of our MorphTE accounts for 5.4% and 3.2% of the model on GPU and CPU, respectively. Compared with the significant parameter/memory reduction, this slight computational overhead is tolerable. In addition, we also found that the time cost of word2ketxs and tensor train methods increased significantly on CPU devices. This may be related to the fact that these two methods have more computational operations under the condition of the same number of parameters.